HMC ONE
AI STRATEGY. BUILT TO SCALE.

CLIENT CASE STUDY · RETAIL · HR

MULTI-CONCEPT RETAIL GROUP · ANNUAL TALENT REVIEW

Succession Planning Workbench

Eight concept spreadsheets and pages of talent notes became one live workbench: talent KPIs, a 9-box that moves year on year, a pipeline for every critical role, and GenAI summaries of the notes.

~~42%~~ → **71%** critical roles with a ready successor



3 weeks
Talent review cycle
▼ from about 9 weeks



71 %
Critical roles with a ready successor
▲ from 42% the year before



8 concepts
Concepts on one view
instead of eight spreadsheets

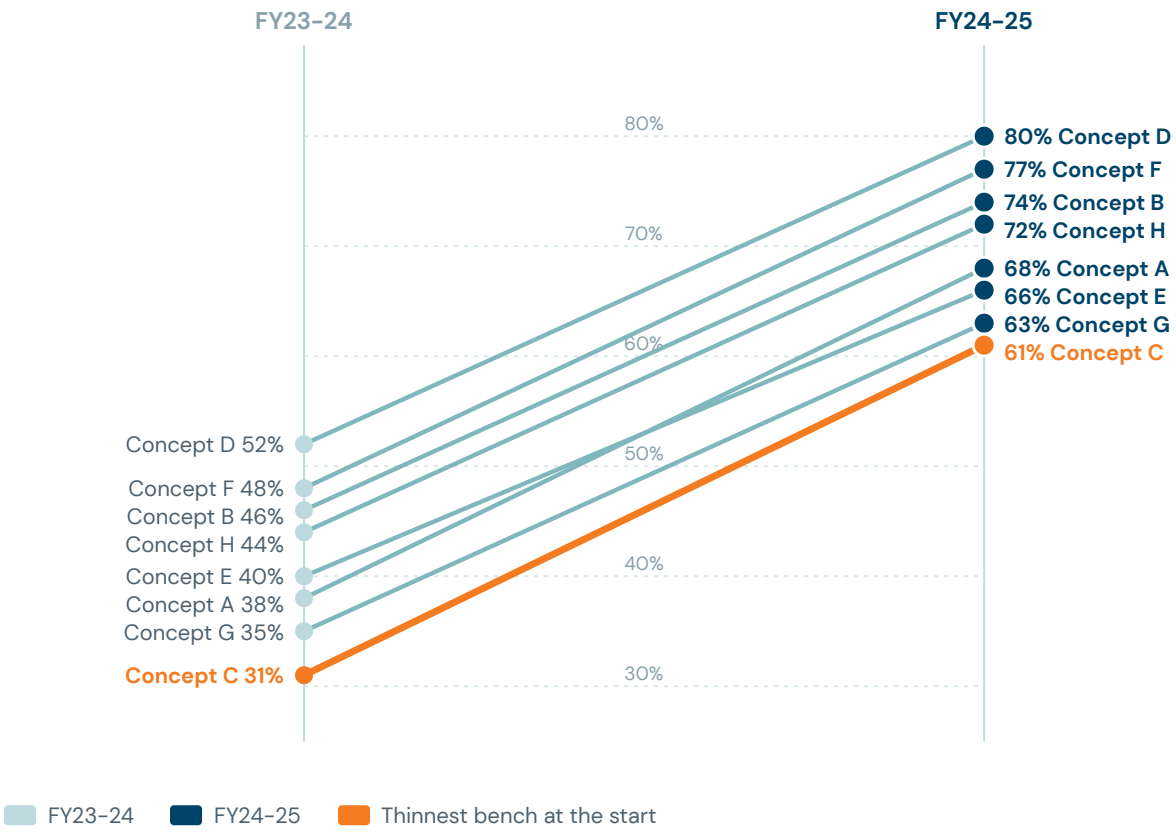


−70 %
Calibration prep time
▼ AI summaries of talent notes

Rings: cycle weeks against the earlier 9 (full inner ring); ready-successor share with last year's 42% inside; one segment per concept; prep time remaining against the old baseline. Figures indicative; validated metrics available on request.

01 Every concept's bench got deeper

Critical roles with a Ready Now or Ready Soon successor, by concept · indicative



BIGGEST TURNAROUND
The thinnest bench nearly doubled
Concept C started at 31%, the lowest in the group, and closed the year at 61%.

ACROSS THE BOARD
All eight concepts moved up
Gains of 26 to 30 points in every concept; none was left behind.

THE LEADER
Concept D sets the bar
From 52% to 80%: four in five critical roles now have a ready successor.

WHY IT MOVED
Risk became visible
Critical roles without a successor, held by someone at high flight risk, showed up live by concept instead of after a resignation.

02 Six views, one dataset

One 35-column file · each view answers one kind of question

ASK Where is our risk?

1 Concept-level view
KPIs side by side for every concept, shaded by health.

2 KPI dashboard
Click any number to see the people behind it.

ASK Who are our people?

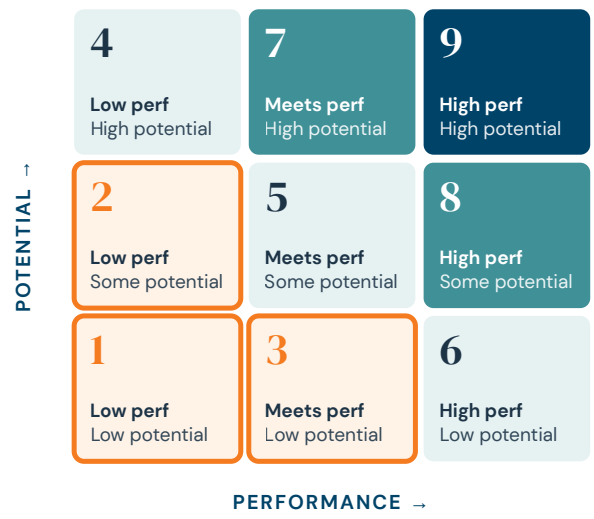
3 Employee list
Filter by concept, role level and year; open any profile.

4 9-box grid
Switch the year to watch people move box.

ASK Who is next? Show me the detail.

5 Succession pipeline
Ready now, soon and later for each role; gaps highlighted.

6 Data view
All 35 columns, with AI summaries of the free-text notes.



The 9-box as used in the workbench, tracked FY22-23 → FY24-25. Boxes 7–9 mark **HIPOs**; boxes 1–3 in a critical role are **weak links**.

KPI DICTIONARY, AGREED FIRST

Critical role
E.g. revenue impact above 20% of the concept, scarce skill, or a single point of failure in the region.

HIPO
A leader in box 7, 8 or 9 of the latest talent rating.

Consistent performer
Rated Exceeds Target or better in every year on record.

Weak link
A critical role held by someone in box 1, 2 or 3.

Succession depth
Share of critical roles with a Ready Now or pipeline successor.

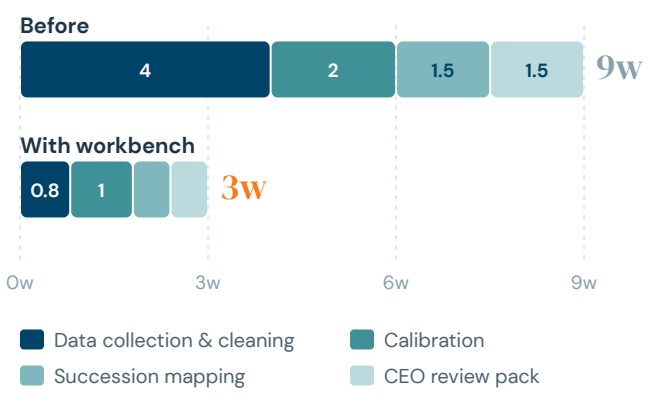
03 Four pain points, four fixes

Before → after

BEFORE	CLEAN ONCE	AFTER
Fragmented data Every concept had its own template, with different spellings, bands and rating scales.		**One cleaned dataset** 35 columns, every concept, with HR's template and rating scales kept.
Notes nobody read Strengths and successor notes ran to paragraphs; calibration ran out of time first.	GENAI SUMMARIES	**Notes back in the room** AI summaries with HR's own prompt replaced reading paragraphs aloud.
Hidden risk Critical roles with no successor and a high flight risk surfaced only at resignation.	LIVE KPIS	**Gaps highlighted** A pipeline by readiness for each role; click any number to see the people.
Slow review cycle Consolidating, cleaning and building CEO slides took about nine weeks a year.	RUN IT LIVE	**About three weeks** Calibration and the CEO review ran from the workbench; actions exported straight after.

04 Where the time went

Talent review cycle by stage, weeks · indicative



9 → 3 weeks per annual talent review

05 How a review runs now

	BEFORE	AFTER
Risk view	Built by hand for the CEO deck	Live KPIs that open to names
9-box	Static slide, one year	Interactive, year-on-year movement
Talent notes	Read aloud in calibration	AI summaries, HR's own prompt
Succession	Names in a notes column	Pipeline by readiness, gaps flagged
Cycle time	About 9 weeks	**About 3 weeks**

06 How HMC ran it

2 weeks	**Discover**	Mapped the 35-column template; agreed the KPI dictionary and cleaning rules.
2 weeks	**Design**	Six views, one dataset; wireframes signed off by Group HR.
3 weeks	**Build**	One offline HTML file built with Claude: no server, no install.
1 cycle	**Adopt**	Calibration and the CEO review run live; HRBPs set status in the room.
∞ ongoing	**Scale**	Quarterly refresh of ratings, attrition risk and readiness.

What transfers to any HR team

01
Define the KPIs before the dashboard
Agreeing what "critical", "HIPO" and "weak link" mean did more for the review than any chart.

02
Every number should open to names
Leaders trust a KPI when one click shows the people behind it.

03
Let AI read the notes
The richest talent data is free text. Summaries in HR's own words put it back into the conversation.

Built with **Claude** · **OpenAI API** (optional) · **Excel / HRMS extract** · **D3.js** · single HTML file | Prepared by Havish M Consulting · Figures indicative; validated metrics available on request.

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